

Log Analysis Assignment

1. Which IP Looks Suspicious?

192.168.1.10 looks the most suspicious because it failed to login 4 times in less than 2 minutes for the same user.

203.0.113.45 also looks suspicious because it successfully logged in twice as admin from an outside IP address which is unusual.

2. What Type of Attack Is This?

The activity from 192.168.1.10 is a Brute Force Attack where the attacker is repeatedly trying different passwords for the same user in a very short time using an automated tool.

The activity from 203.0.113.45 is an Unauthorized Access where someone successfully logged in as admin from an unknown external IP address which should not be happening.

3. Why Do You Think It Is Suspicious?

Reason 1: Too Many Failed Attempts in Very Short Time The IP address 192.168.1.10 failed to login 4 times within just 45 seconds from 10:17:45 to 10:18:30. A real user who forgets their password would not try 4 times in 45 seconds. This shows an automated program is trying to guess the password.

Reason 2: Admin Login from External IP The IP address 203.0.113.45 successfully logged in as admin twice. The IP 203.0.113.45 is an external public IP address and not from the local network. Admin accounts should never be accessed from unknown outside IP addresses. This strongly indicates unauthorized access.

Reason 3: Pattern Difference Between user2 and the Suspicious IPs Looking at user2 we can see 2 failed attempts and then 1 successful login which is normal human behavior of simply forgetting the password. But 192.168.1.10 had 4 rapid failures with no success which is the pattern of a brute force attack.